

School Management

1. How do you assess efficient use of studios and opening hours?

We look at how many lesson slots are actually filled against the total slots available during opening hours. With five studios, every unused 30-minute slot is potential lost income, especially during the more popular after-school and weekend periods. We would want to see where studios are underused, whether the drum studio is becoming a bottleneck, and whether teacher availability is preventing us from accepting students.

2. What reports do you need to track profitability and room utilisation?

A monthly management report should show studio utilisation by day, time, studio and instrument; scheduled versus available lesson slots; teacher workload and requested versus allocated hours; cancellations, reschedules and unassigned students. A simple summary of the busiest periods, lowest-utilised periods and lessons lost due to unavailable teachers or rooms would be particularly useful.

3. How do you tell whether a monthly schedule went well, and what happens when full studios conflict with teacher preferences?

A good schedule is one where students receive consistent lessons, studios are well used, teachers receive a fair share of the hours they requested, and managers are not constantly making last-minute changes. We would not fill rooms at any cost. A teacher who is overloaded, unavailable or repeatedly assigned against their preferences is unlikely to stay with us. We would prioritise legal and wellbeing constraints first, then student continuity, then room utilisation and teacher preferences. Where there is a genuine conflict, we would prefer a sustainable roster over a superficially full one.

4. What is the biggest operational cost related to scheduling?

The largest hidden cost is usually unused teaching capacity: an empty studio, an available teacher and a student waiting for a lesson all at the same time represents lost revenue. Last-minute cancellations and manual rework also consume managers' time. We should therefore make unused slots, unassigned students and avoidable schedule conflicts highly visible.

5. How do you track whether teachers are satisfied with their hours?

At present, this is mostly based on conversations and comparing the hours teachers asked for with the hours actually assigned. The system should make that comparison explicit for every teacher, including their preferred days or lesson patterns. It should also flag persistent gaps, such as someone repeatedly receiving fewer hours than requested, so managers can discuss the issue before it becomes a retention problem.

6. What should a single operations-health dashboard show?

It should give us an immediate picture of studio utilisation, booked lessons, unassigned students, teacher workload distribution, teachers nearing their limits, pending job rejections, and conflicts requiring action. I would also want a short trend view so we can tell whether utilisation, cancellations or staffing pressure are improving or getting worse month by month.

External Stakeholders

1. What labour guidelines must the school monitor and demonstrate compliance with?

The system should retain an auditable roster showing each teacher's assigned hours, breaks, rest days, overtime and changes. For staff covered by Part 4 of Singapore's Employment Act, the relevant baseline includes limits on normal hours, a weekly rest day, restrictions on excessive daily and monthly overtime, and break requirements. The exact statutory coverage depends on role and salary, so employment contracts and HR should remain the authority for each individual case. The school should also enforce its own stricter operational rule: no more than four continuous teaching hours followed by at least one hour's break. Current MOM guidance generally limits covered employees to 44 normal hours a week, 12 hours a day, 72 overtime hours a month, and normally requires a break after no more than six continuous hours. [MOM: Hours of work, overtime and rest day](#)

2. What is the school's strength?

The school has a focused, specialist offering: individual 30-minute lessons across piano, drums, violin and trumpet, supported by dedicated studios. It is clearly trying to retain qualified teachers by giving them meaningful work, which is important in a market where good music instructors are difficult to find. Its challenge is not a lack of demand, but coordinating teachers, students and limited specialist resources well enough to turn that demand into a reliable schedule.

3. How do you coordinate instrument servicing?

We would need a clear point of contact, usually a manager or IT administrator, who records the studio, instrument, issue and preferred servicing window. The system should let us mark the affected studio or equipment as unavailable for a defined period, preventing lessons from being assigned there by mistake. After servicing, the record should show what was done, when the instrument was returned to service and whether any follow-up is due.

4. What are the consequences of labour non-compliance?

Non-compliance can result in regulatory investigation, required corrective action, financial penalties or other enforcement consequences, depending on the breach. It also creates a practical risk: payroll disputes, teacher dissatisfaction, fatigue, avoidable turnover and damage to the school's reputation. From our perspective, the most important control is prevention: the system should block or prominently flag problematic allocations before the roster is published, while preserving an audit trail of any authorised exception.

These responses are grounded in the project rules and stakeholder context in , the interview question set in , and the existing IT and operational constraints in .